March 2026

Kevin Roberts, President
The Heritage Foundation
214 Massachusetts Avenue NE
Washington, DC 20002
Phone: (202) 546-4400

Dear President Roberts,

The Heritage Foundation has long argued that strong families, strong communities, and limited government are the pillars of American freedom. The National Experiential Civic Education Framework is built on exactly those foundations — and I write to ask whether Heritage would consider reviewing and endorsing it.

NECEF proposes structured civic programming in schools — community service, emergency preparedness, infrastructure stewardship, and leadership development — with three features that should appeal directly to Heritage's principles. First, state and local communities retain complete control over program design and content. Second, the framework builds on existing federal infrastructure (AmeriCorps, FEMA CERT, Title IV) rather than creating new federal agencies or mandates. Third, the program produces self-reliant, community-capable citizens — the antithesis of government dependency.

The historical grounding is conservative to its core. The Federalist Papers, Tocqueville's observations on civic association, and the Founders' insistence on an educated and virtuous citizenry are the intellectual foundations of this proposal. This is not a progressive reimagining of education. It is a recovery of what education in a republic has always required.

A Heritage review and endorsement — even a conditional one focused on the state flexibility provisions — would provide the conservative credibility necessary to build genuine bipartisan support. I would welcome the opportunity to brief your policy team at your convenience.

Respectfully,

Gina Aulabaugh